



“With the introduction of Snaps, continually optimising Firefox will become possible, providing Linux users with the most up-to-date features,” said Nick Nguyen, VP of product, Firefox, at Mozilla.

As Nguyen mentioned, the easy upgradability will influence Linux developers to use the Snapcraft tool and design new Snappy packages for multiple Linux distributions. The platform could be Arch, Debian, Fedora, GNOME or some Ubuntu-based operating systems like Kubuntu, Lubuntu or Ubuntu Mate.

Canonical founder Mark Shuttleworth said that the new launch will provide a consistent foundation for emerging hardware developments like LoRa and beacons. “We do see Snap packages providing a consistent foundation to enable broader distribution and a universal marketplace for these types of innovative connectivity services,” Shuttleworth said in response to OSFY’s question during the launch webcast of the new format.

Developers on platforms like CentOS, Gentoo, Mint, OpenSUSE, OpenWrt and RHEL are set to design new Snap packages. Also, several Linux distributions can run Snaps alongside other packages.

When asked about the ease of developing Snaps for multiple Linux distributions, Shuttleworth said that developers can create single Snap packages for different platforms. “As long as the Snappy — the Snap mechanism that has been ported for the Linux distro — will work, you don’t have to do things differently to make a Snap that works across multiple platforms. That’s what is really beautiful about this new Snap format. I initially thought we would get Debian Snaps and Firefox Snaps, but we ended up with the universal Snap solution,” he said.

Snapd will be the new Snap format, while its community work is already available for free on GitHub. Hardware like Samsung’s ARTIK IoT modules and Dell will be the first ones to run Snaps, out-of-the-box.

Apple opens iMessage and Siri to developers

Apple, at its WWDC 2016, pleased hundreds and thousands of app developers by announcing some major new updates for iMessage and Siri. The iPhone maker also previewed iOS 10 as the successor to the last year’s iOS 9, and released the Swift Playgrounds app for iPad to teach coding concepts in an easy way.

Craig Federighi, Apple’s senior vice president of software engineering, took the stage at the developer conference to announce a revamped version of iMessage. This new upgrade has some room for third-party developers.



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